



IN BRIEF

NEW BEGINNINGS

The colonization of the New World brought new opportunities for female settlers, but came at the expense of indigenous women, whose way of life came under attack.

1500

• **1503** Anacaona, a Taíno chief, is executed in Hispaniola when the Spanish massacre her people during a supposedly diplomatic visit.

1600

• **1608** Two female British colonists arrive in Jamestown, the first permanent English settlement in North America.

• **1613-1614** A year after she is captured by British settlers, Pocahontas is baptized as a Christian and marries John Rolfe.

• **1662** Virginia law makes slavery inherited upon the condition of mothers.

• **1663** King Louis XIV begins a program to send about 800 *filles du roi*, or unmarried women, to New France to supplement the population of its Canadian colony.

• **1671** Awashonks, the female chief of the Sakonnet tribe in Seconet, Rhode Island, signs a peace agreement with Plymouth Colony and other Native American leaders.

• **1691** Virginia passes a law forbidding free white women from marrying non-whites, including Native American men.

• **1692** Hundreds of women are accused of witchcraft in Salem, Massachusetts, resulting in the execution of 14 women and 5 men.

1700

• **1756** Lydia Taft becomes the first woman to legally vote in colonial America at a town hall meeting in Uxbridge, Massachusetts.

• **1773** Phillis Wheatley publishes the anthology, *Poems on Various Subjects, Religious and Moral*, bringing her fame throughout the Atlantic World.

◀ **WOMEN ARRIVE IN JAMESTOWN TO MARRY SETTLERS, AS DEPICTED BY WILLIAM LUDWELL SHEPPARD IN 1876.**

